

Interview Preparation Guide — DevOps Engineer

1. CI/CD

Pipeline design (build/test/deploy stages), blue-green vs. canary deployments, and rollback strategies.

2. Containers and Orchestration

Docker fundamentals, Kubernetes basics (pods, deployments, services, ingress, autoscaling), and debugging a crash-looping pod.

3. Infrastructure as Code

Terraform state management, modules, and handling drift between actual infra and code.

Scenario-Based Questions

Scenario-based questions test applied judgment rather than textbook recall — interviewers are usually more interested in your reasoning process than the exact final answer.

Scenario: A deployment just went out and error rates are climbing. Walk through your rollback and incident-response steps in the first 10 minutes.

Scenario: Your CI pipeline takes 25 minutes per run and the team is complaining about slow feedback. How would you speed it up?

Scenario: A cost report shows cloud spend doubled last month with no corresponding traffic increase. How do you investigate?

Questions by Experience Level

The bar for the same topic area rises sharply by level. Below is a representative question for a DevOps Engineer at each tier, showing how depth of expected answer changes — not just difficulty of the question itself.

Intern: Q: What's the difference between a Docker image and a Docker container?

Entry-Level: Q: Write a basic Dockerfile for a simple Python web app.

Associate Engineer: Q: How would you set up alerting for an API so the team is notified before customers notice a problem, without causing alert fatigue?

Engineer: Q: Design a CI/CD pipeline for a team shipping to production multiple times a day.

Senior: Q: How would you plan and execute a zero-downtime migration of a production database to a new instance type?

Principal: Q: How would you define an org-wide incident-response and on-call standard across several independent teams with different tech stacks?